



Fastest full touch handset

The current title holder is the recently launched Samsung Jet which boasts an 800 MHz processor.



Fold

Nokia's latest clamshell phone, the 3710 fold, combines style and functionality

A new iPhone... about time

Apple recently unveiled the iPhone 3G S – a faster version of its popular smart phone. Yes, the 'S' stands for speed; trust Apple to come up with something simple, even in the naming convention. So what's so special about the 3G S? Is it just an iPhone 3G with the new OS 3 software preinstalled? Certainly not. Although the 3G S may have the new OS 3, it's faster functioning lies mainly in the hardware. Many of the 3G S UI functions including copy and paste, MMS support, the new Voice Memos app, and search capabilities are part of the iPhone 3.0 software update. And consequently will be available to iPhone 3G users who simply upgrade to the new firmware.

spec comparison charts.

However a T-Mobile web page reportedly had put up hardware specs of the new phone. The page was instantly pulled down but several reports suggest that the page showed the 3G S to have a 600 MHz processor and 256 MB RAM. The iPhone 3G on the other hand had a 412 MHz processor and 128 MB RAM. So, twice the ram equals twice the speed? Going by what was said at the WWDC keynote during the phone's unveiling, most functions in the phone, including launching apps, opening web pages, and viewing attachments, will be at least twice as fast. The numbers thrown about were in the range of 2.4 to 3.6 times for different functions.

reports also suggest that the phone has a new graphics chip – Imagination Technologies' PowerVR SGX. This chip supports a shader-driven tile-based deferred rendering architecture.

The phone sports a better camera this time around. The camera is supposed to take better pictures compared to any of the earlier models thanks to the improved pixel count. The 3G S come with a 3 MP camera instead of the 2 MP one on the earlier model. The camera will work much faster in line with the other hardware improvements. Along with the camera come additional features such as auto-macro picture capability and 'tap to focus'. This feature allows you to tap and focus on any part of the screen. By default, the iPhone would focus on the centre of the screen but now you can tap on, say, an object in the background to focus on. Not only will the app now focus on it, it will also automatically adjust other settings such as white balance and exposure.

To give a Boy Scout helping hand to some of us who are directionally challenged, Apple has a built-in digital compass in the 3G S. The compass will tell the phone which direction you are facing even when you are stationary. Earlier this was figured out via GPS by judging your direction of movement. In the maps application the maps will automatically reorient themselves to the direction the user is facing. This should definitely help in navigation.

So, is there anything different in terms of looks? Not really. In fact we had difficulty telling the difference while



iPhone 3G S and the compass feature

watching the video tour of the 3G S on the Apple web site. As for the body, it is supposed to have a new oil resistant coating that will make cleaning the phone easier. About time that they did something about the finger smudges.

Let's now conclude with the aspect that worries all of us – price. How much does the iPhone 3G S cost? The contractual schemes under which it is available through a network operator are as complicated as our constitution. But the full price of the phone without a network lock-in is \$599 for a 16-GB model and \$699 for a 32-GB.

Augmented reality browser

Imagine looking through your phone's camera. You see a couple of buildings, and within moments an overlay starts displaying all sorts of information about them. The kind of information you see will include, say, the price of the building, information on various establishments located within, such as bars and restaurants, and even whether there are jobs available there. Kind of reminds you of the heads-up display we saw in Terminator 3. Particularly the sequence where Arnie analyses clothes sizes for himself with information constantly being displayed on screen, and



Tap to focus and the improved 3MP Camera

What then do the innards of the new iPhone hold in terms of hardware? Well, no one is quite sure yet and Apple as always is tight lipped about the specs of the iPhone. Why should it bother with giving out specs anyway? Since the time of its launch Apple has sold the iPhone based on its design, mind blowing UI, and the bountiful app store. Not

It's not just the speed of the iPhone 3G S that's sent joygasms down the spines of geeks worldwide. The phone reportedly is going to come with graphics that will equal, if not surpass, some of today's gaming handhelds. The phone supports an advanced graphics API for mobile phones – the OpenGL ES 2.0. Unconfirmed